

who have annual incomes in the \$50,000 to \$200,000 range but who are not millionaires. Their shopping habits certainly have something to do with the fact that they are not wealthy. Who are these people? Typically, they do not own their own businesses. They are more likely to be corporate middle managers (especially those who are part of a working couple), attorneys, sales and marketing professionals, and physicians.

Why would anyone suggest that you spend more than the typical millionaire for a suit? In a recently published article, an owner of very expensive suits touted that they were an excellent investment (Lawrence Minard, “You’re Looking Rather Prosperous, Sir,” *Forbes*, April 8, 1996, pp. 132–133). Mr. Minard asks and answers the question of questions about investing in suits:

Can custom-made suits be worth \$2,000? Mine are. Fourteen years and 14 pounds later, they still look good.... Believe it or not I made an excellent investment (Minard, p. 132).

Mr. Minard tells his readers how he was initially guided to the custom tailor shops of London’s Savile Row by two senior-level executives whom he regarded as having “excellent taste” but were not “frivolous” in their buying habits:

They explained that to buy bespoke is to enter into a unique and personal relationship with your clothes (Minard, p. 132).

What is the meaning of *bespoke*? In middle-class American, it means custom-made. Johnny Lucas never bought a custom-made suit. Does he have a “unique and personal relationship” with his all-wool, top-of-the-line JC Penney suit? (Are you surprised to learn that some millionaires shop at Penney’s? Perhaps even more surprising, about 30.4 percent of the respondents who are millionaires hold JC Penney credit cards.) Penney’s private-brand Stafford Executive suits were recently given top scores for durability, cut, and fit by a leading consumer publication: